Siri Vajirārāma Library — Full Website Rebuild Spec

Site: `lib.vajirarama.lk` Type: Multi-page website (header + footer + content pages) Language: English (Sinhala variants for select content)

I've separated real content from theme demo junk (lorem ipsum, WooCommerce ebook pages, "Page 1–5," theme-feature pages, author/date archives). Everything below is the real content, organized into a proper site.

1. SITEMAP

/ → Home
/about/ → About (landing / overview)
  /about/vision-mission/ → Vision & Mission
  /about/history/ → History
  /about/centenary/ → Centenary (100 Years)
  /about/former-librarians/ → Former Librarians
  /about/persons/ → People (Patrons & Committee)
  /about/floor-plan/ → Library Floor Plan
  /about/policies/ → Policies
  /about/general-guide/ → General Guide
/collection/ → Collection
/services/ → Services
/publications/ → Publications
/membership/ → Membership (landing)
  /membership/opening-hours/ → Opening Hours
  /membership/register/ → Registration
  /membership/download/ → Download Forms
/contact/ → Contact Us

Legacy URL redirects (301 →):

Legacy	New
`/vision-and-mission/`, `/mission/`, `/general-guide/`	`/about/vision-mission/`

/centenary/, /siri-vajirarama-library/, /vajirarama-temple-library/	/about/history/
/persons/	/about/persons/
/library-floor-plan/	/about/floor-plan/
/policies/	/about/policies/
/former-librarians/	/about/former-librarians/
/opening-hours-2/, /opening-hours/	/membership/opening-hours/
/membership-registtration/	/membership/register/
/download-3/	/membership/download/

2. GLOBAL HEADER

Layout: Logo left · Nav center · Search + OPAC button right

[🪷 Siri Vajirārāma Library] Home About▾ Collection Services Publications Membership▾ Contact [🔍 Search] [OPAC →]

Logo: https://lib.vajirarama.lk/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/cropped-Library-Logo1111-1.png

Dropdown contents

About ▾

- Vision & Mission
- History
- Centenary
- Former Librarians
- People
- Library Floor Plan
- Policies
- General Guide

Membership ▾

- Opening Hours
- Register
- Download Forms

Mobile: Hamburger → full-screen slide menu with nested accordion.

Top utility bar (thin strip above header):

`📞 +94 11 259 2140 · ✉ library@vajirarama.lk · 📍 Vajira Road, Colombo 04`

3. GLOBAL FOOTER

4-column footer + copyright bar

Column 1 — About the Library

> The Siri Vajirarama Library, inaugurated by the Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajirañāṇa Mahānāyaka Thero, was a repository of knowledge of the venerable monks and scholars of that era who worked to bring Buddhism to the world. It is unquestionably recognized as a globally renowned Sri Lankan Buddhist library.

Column 2 — Quick Links

- About Us
- Vision & Mission
- History
- Collection
- Services
- Membership
- Contact Us

Column 3 — Resources

- OPAC (Catalogue)

- Digital Library
- Publications
- Download Forms
- Library Floor Plan
- Opening Hours

Column 4 — Contact

Siri Vajirārāma Library
No. 14, Vajira Road
Colombo 04, Sri Lanka

📞 +94 11 259 2140
✉ library@vajirarama.lk

Follow us: [Facebook] [YouTube] [LinkedIn]

Copyright bar

> © 2026 Siri Vajirārāma Library. All rights reserved.
>
> ⚠️ Note: Source footer says "Colombo 04" but Contact Us page says "Colombo 05". Bambalapitiya = Colombo 04. Fix the Contact page.

4. HOME PAGE (`/`)

H1: Welcome to Siri Vajirārāma Library

Hero: Full-width image (`WhatsApp-Image-2025-01-11-at-20.57.31.jpeg`) + short tagline.

Quick Access Grid (4 cards)

Card	Icon	Description	Link
Catalogue	`catalogue-2.png`	Online Public Access Catalogue (OPAC) will allow you to search for material available in the Siri Vajirarama Library. The Library uses the KOHA Library Management System to maintain the OPAC.	→ OPAC

Digital Library	`elearning.png`	Taking into consideration the modern world trend in the library and information field, Siri Vajirarama Library has taken steps to initiate a Siri Vajirarama Digital Library and Repository. The Digital Library uses the DSpace software.	→ Digital Library
Membership	`restaurant-membership-card-tool.png`	Membership of the Siri Vajirarama Library is now available. Vajirarama Library, which has a century-old history, has a special collection of books and periodicals. Readers who obtain membership will have access to the library's resources.	→ Register
Publications	`public-relations.png`	Monthly publications of the Bambalapitiya Siri Vajiraramaya and books, magazines and periodicals published under the name Siri Vajiraramaya can be read online.	→ Publications

Section: About Us

> The Siri Vajirarama Library, inaugurated by the Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajirajanana Mahanayake Thero, a renowned monk of the 20th century, was a repository of knowledge of the venerable monks and scholars of that era who worked to bring Buddhism to the world. It is unquestionably recognized as a globally renowned Sri Lankan Buddhist library.

(Add "Read more →" link to `/about/`)

Section: Founder's Words (blockquote)

Header: Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thera

> "We highly appreciate the honour of your presence in our midst on this happy occasion; and we thank you sincerely for your kindness in accepting our invitation; and thus, giving encouragement to our present enterprise, which has for its ultimate goal the moral and intellectual development of the country. Though much might be said on such an occasion I shall avail myself of the opportunity to speak a few words in connection with the library which you are about to declare open. Hitherto these books numbering about 2000, were my private property; but it is my earnest desire now to inaugurate a public library with these books as a nucleus, so that everyone may have access to it and benefit thereby."

> — Speech at the official opening of the Vajirarama Library by the Colonial Secretary, Mr. Cecil Clement, 15 July 1924

Image caption: Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thero was lined up with his few monk disciples and some dayakas in front of the Vajirarama Library.

Image: `WhatsApp-Image-2025-01-11-at-20.57.31.jpeg`

Section: A Resource Centre for Learning

> A good library is always a resource centre for learning.
>
> Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thero developed such a resource centre for the single purpose of learning the Dhamma.
>
> Using the library that he developed with love and devotion, he became the 'last word' on matters pertaining to the Dhamma and Vinaya during his time. He had a lineup of pupil monks starting with Venerable Narada Maha Thera (1916), followed by Venerable Kamburugamuwe Mahanāga (1920), Venerable Denipitiye Sumanasiri (1923), Venerable Madihe Paṅṅāsīha (1924), Venerable Piyadassi (1934), Venerable Soma, Venerable Kheminda, Venerable Pamburana Metteyya, Venerable Ampitiye Rāhula (1936), Venerable Naotunne Gunasiri (1937), Venerable Walgama Sugatananda (1939), Venerable Panwila Vipassi (1939), Venerable Urugamuwe Senananda (1939), Venerable Amritananda of Nepal (1940), Venerable Kassapa (1947), Venerable Ňāṇavīra of England (1950) and Venerable Ňāṇamoli of England. None of the erudite monks ordained before 1940 went to a university as an undergraduate or to a pirivena to follow a course of studies in Buddha Dhamma. Their education and training were directed by the Most Venerable Pelene Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thero and the Vajirarama Library was their resource centre for learning.

Section: Venerable Madihe Paṅṅāsīha Thero (quote box)

> A unique test was when Venerable Madihe Paṅṅāsīha Thero, still in his late twenties, was desirous of following the Vidyā Vishāradha course commenced by Professor G. P. Malalasekera at the University College, Colombo. Although Venerable Paṅṅāsīha Thero did not have the stipulated paper qualifications to gain entry to the course, a letter from Venerable Pelene Mahānāyaka Thero to the University authorities stating that his knowledge of Pali, Sanskrit and the Buddhist texts was more than adequate, enabled him to follow the course, which he completed successfully.

CTA Banner

> How can we help you?
>
> Ready to take the next step? Explore our services and get in touch today for a consultation.

[Explore Services] [Contact Us]

5. ABOUT PAGES

5.1 `/about/` — About (Landing Page)

H1: About the Library

Short intro + card grid linking to each sub-page:

Card	Subtitle
Vision & Mission	"The Buddha's Teaching for All"
History	From 1924 to today
Centenary	100 years of learning
Former Librarians	Those who served
People	Patrons & Committee
Library Floor Plan	Three floors, three collections
Policies	Rules & guidelines
General Guide	Visitor information

5.2 `/about/vision-mission/`

H1: Vision & Mission

Vision

"The Buddha's Teaching for All"

Mission

> To develop the library as a resource centre for providing an impetus to produce an erudite society and for preserving the Buddhist intellectual heritage. In pursuance of such, develop a collection of palm leaf manuscripts, rare books, and contemporary printed matter on Buddhism and all other comparative subjects in physical and digitized formats for use of local and foreign bhikkhus and lay scholars, desiring to enhance their knowledge and undertake research on Buddhism and comparative subjects, and those who are engaged in propagating the Buddha Dhamma throughout the world.

5.3 `/about/history/`

H1: History of the Siri Vajirārāma Library

Combine the three real history sources (`/centenary/`, `/siri-vajirarama-library/`, `/vajirarama-temple-library/`) into one narrative. Centenary has the most detailed story — use it as the base.

Sub-headings inside the page (anchor jump nav on left):

1. Origins (1901–1924)
2. The Library Building (1924)
3. The Founder's Vision
4. The Pupil Monks
5. After the Founder (1955–2009)
6. A New Era (2009–2024)
7. The Centenary Building (2024)
8. Legacy

Origins (1901–1924)

> The Vajiraramaya temple was founded and inaugurated as a place of worship and residence for monks in 1901, by the Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thera. On September 6, 2009, the government of Sri Lanka declared it a Sacred Site.
>
> Imperative it is to record a few facts about this venerable monk, though his life story is well known. He was born in Pelene, a village in Weligama in the District of Matara, on July 28, 1878, and named Aron Pandita Gunawardene. His father was Muhandiram Don Andiris Tudawe Pandita Gunawardene, an Oriental scholar of repute. At the age of 15, on July 20, 1890, he got ordained under the tutelage of Weragampitiya Sri Revata Maha Thero and in 1897 he was admitted to Vidyodaya Pirivena. He was residing at Siri Suvusuddharamaya in Wellawatte. Meanwhile, the Buddhists in Bambalapitiya formed the Dhamma Samagama and built a hall for bana preaching on the site of the present Vajiraramaya temple. Persuaded by the Dhamma Samagama to reside in a

small avasa built for the purpose, Ven. Pelene Vajiraṅāṇa Thera acceded to the request.

He was elevated to the position of Head of the Amarapura Siri Dharmarakshitha Nikaya on August 05, 1918, and had a host of pupils who would shine forth as erudite, disciplined, dhammaduta monks who introduced a new and more popular style of bana preaching and travelled across the oceans spreading the word of the Buddha.

The Library Building (1924)

On 15th July 1924, the present Siri Vajirarama library building at Vajira Road, Bambalapitiya was opened. Venerable Pelene Vajiranana Mahanayaka Thera invited Cecil Clement, Colonial Secretary of Ceylon, for the inauguration ceremony. The building was donated by G. J. de Silva and James Peiris with 2000 books and two rooms for two resident monks.

The Oriental Library of Vajiraramaya temple, with Head Monk Ven. Pelene Siri Vajiraṅāṇa Maha Thera, was formally declared open on July 15, 1924, by Colonial Secretary Hon. Cecil Clement. Mr and Mrs G. J. Silva were chief benefactors. By then, the 100 volumes of the Head Monk had increased vastly.

Pull-quote (from The Searchlight, Saturday July 19, 1924):

"The collection of 2000 odd books of rare value and importance, the gift of the learned High Priest, ought to, as Mayor Reid remarked, 'be a source of enlightenment and good to the citizens of Colombo.' The generosity of Mr. G. J. Silva in providing an excellent building and furniture to enable those books to be housed for public inspection and reference is an augury for the future of Buddhist learning in Ceylon."

The Founder's Vision (from his opening speech, 1924)

(Use the full quote from Home page's "Founder's Words" section — the long passage from the speech.)

— Times newspaper, July 16, 1924

The Pupil Monks

Most of the erudite monks ordained before 1940 did not go to a university as undergraduates or to a pirivena to follow a course of studies in Buddha Dhamma. Their education and training were directed by the Most Venerable Pelene Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thero and the Vajirarama Library was their resource centre for learning.

Venerable Pelene Mahanayaka Thera was himself a great scholar and encouraged his pupil monks to follow his path. Most of his pupil monks, in later times, became well known both nationally and internationally. Among them were: (1) Narada, (2) Kaburugamuwe Mahanama, (3) Denipitiye Sumanasiri, (4)

Madihe Pannasiha, (5) Piyadassi, (6) Ampitiye Rahula, (7) Soma Kassapa, (8) Kheminda and (9) Metteyya. They were prolific users of this library.

It may also be noted that Prof. Gunapala Malalasekara, Sir D. B. Jayatilake and W. A. Silva were among the first generation of Vajirarama library users. In the 1950s, among the second generation users were Olcott Gunasekera, K. D. G. Wimalaratne and D. C. Ranatunga. In short, this library helped not only the Sangha students of Venerable Pelene Vajiranana Mahanayaka Thera but also laymen in their studies and research.

After the Founder (1955–2009)

The demise of Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraṅāṇa Mahānāyaka Thero in 1955 seems to have had a long-term effect on the evolution of the Vajirarama library. By then, almost all his pupils had become Maha Theras with over twenty years after higher ordination and were leaving the Vajirarama conclave to be of greater service to the Sasana and the community. For example, Venerable Madihe Paññāsīha Maha Thera and Venerable Ampitiye Rāhula Mahā Thera left to fulfil a wish of their teacher to set up the Bhikkhu Training Centre at Maharagama. There were similar developments in other places where branches of Vajiraramaya sprang up like Asokārāmaya at Nuwara Eliya, Bodhigiri Vihāraya at Pælvādiya, Ratnapura, Samarasinghārāmaya at Telijjavila, and Senanayakaramaya at Kandy. No new pupil monks were ordained who could benefit from the temple library. Hence, there seems to have been a slow change of the Vajirarama library to become a mere treasure trove of knowledge.

The Buddha has once stated "Tathāgatappavedito dhammavinayo, bhikkhave, vivaṭo virocati, no paṭicchanno" (Anguttara Nikaya, Tika Nipata). Its meaning is: "O Bhikkhus, the teaching and discipline declared by the Tathāgata shines when manifest and not when covered." In the same way, a library shines only when it is used and not when it is simply preserved as a treasure trove of knowledge even if the books, papers and monograms are written on golden leaves.

A New Era (2009–2024)

A new era dawned with the appointment of Venerable Tirikunamale Ananda Maha Thera, a senior pupil of Most Venerable Madihe Paññāsīha Mahānāyaka Thera, as the chief abbot of Vajiraramaya in February 2009. By then he was also the Anunāyaka or Deputy Chief of the Amarapura Sri Dhammaraksita Nikāya in recognition of his erudition and the monastic qualities he possessed. Comparatively young and bubbling with new ideas, he started with great earnestness for the betterment of Vajiraramaya as its new head.

On September 6, 2009, the Vajirarama temple precincts was declared a sacred area by a special gazette notification; an event that occurred with the participation of Hon. Mahinda Rajapaksa, then President of the Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka, and in the presence of Mr. Dinesh Gunawardena, then Minister of Urban Development and Sacred Area Development. As a mark of respect to his late revered teacher, Most Venerable

Madihe Paňňāsīha Mahānāyaka Thera, a lifelike statue of the prelate was unveiled on the same day. The name Vajiraramaya was changed to Siri Vajiraramaya. Accordingly, Vajirarama Library became Siri Vajirarama Library. It was not only a change of name but also a change of perception.

As Siri Vajiraramaya's contribution to commemorate the Sambuddhatva Jayanti that marked the 2600th year of the enlightenment of the Buddha, the decision was taken to improve the facilities of the library. It needed expansion to accommodate the 11 extra cupboards, of which two contained 210 invaluable ola books, that were located on the first floor of the two-storied Dharma Sala building. There were no reading room facilities for its users either.

A publication dated 05.10.2011 that was printed on the occasion of the opening of the new reading room provides a good assessment of the condition of the library at that time: "The main objective of the current project is to rebuild and restore the Siri Vajirarama Library to take its rightful place among the Buddhist libraries in Sri Lanka for use of local and foreign members of the Maha Sangha and lay researchers." The two words 'rebuild and restore' speak volumes regarding the state of the library that was.

Most Venerable Tirikunamale Ananda Mahānāyaka Thero contacted former Archivist Dr. K. D. G. Wimalaratne and, on his initiative, a team consisting of Professor Piyadasa Ranasinghe, Professor W. A. Weerasuriya, and Mrs. Priyanwada Wanigasooriya of the Faculty of Library and Information Science of the University of Kelaniya visited Siri Vajiraramaya and, after inspection of the library, a comprehensive project report was prepared for the improvement of facilities of the library in stages. It included the following: Rearranging and classification of books; Physical extensions to the library to have reading room and reference facilities and to accommodate all books of the library in one location; Restoring books and ola leaf books that were in a dilapidated condition; Computerization of the Library.

Plaque quote box:

Yuňjatha Buddhasāsane

In honour of the late Venerable Aggamahapandita Madihe Paňňāsīha Mahānāyaka Thera, 'Deshamanya N. U. Jayawardena Reading Room' was gifted to the Siri Vajirarama Library by the N. U. Jayawardena Trust in commemoration of the 2600 Sambuddhatva Jayanti Year.

— 2555/2011 Oct. 05

This was an important milestone in the history of the Siri Vajirarama library. Work commenced also on items 1, 3 and 4 of the Project with the assistance of the Library and Information Science department of the Kelaniya University. For the first time, the books were classified according to the Dewey Decimal Classification and entered in an Accession Register. The necessary data were fed into a computer that was gifted to the library. Much of this work was done by

the students of the Kelaniya University under the supervision of Dr. W. A. Weerasuriya, its head, and the students were made a payment according to an agreed scheme. A lay librarian was appointed to co-ordinate the work.

In 2014, after the demise of Most Venerable Weligama Ňāṇaratana Mahānāyaka Thera, Venerable Tirikunamale Ananda Anunāyaka Thera, the Viharadhipati or Abbot of Siri Vajiraramaya, was unanimously elected the Mahānāyaka Thera or head of the Amarapura Sri Dharmarakshitha Nikāya. For better management and greater efficiency, some functions were devolved and, following earlier tradition, in 2016 the Most Venerable Tirikunamale Ananda Mahānāyaka Thera appointed a bhikkhu from Siri Vajiraramaya as the Librarian-in-charge of the library.

The Centenary Building (2024)

The Siri Vajirarama Library needed to be modernized to meet the needs of the 21st century and to equip it for those who wish to learn more about Buddhism. During a two-year transition period for the modernization, the library was closed to its users. On 14 July 2024/2568, the renovated library, housed in a new three-story building constructed for the purpose, was officially opened to local and foreign users.

The new building is situated behind the old library that was ceremonially opened on July 15, 1924. The old library building, left intact because of its antiquity value, houses the new Relic Chamber or Dhātu Mandiraya. It has many new features tailor-made to fit into a hundred-year-old building and is a bountiful gift of Mrs. Kalsa Amarasinghe, immediate past President of the Siri Vajirarama Sāsana Sāvika Samitiya.

Quote box:

"The historic Siri Vajirarama library that conserved the books and papers of Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraňāṇa Mahānāyaka Thera was opened by Hon. Cecil Clement, the Colonial Secretary of Ceylon, on 15 July 1924. As an expression of great devotion to the Buddha Sasana, this three-storied library was constructed and offered to the Maha Sangha by Mr. Ishara Nanayakkara, Chairman of LOLC and the Browns Group of Companies, for the good and welfare of both the Buddha Sasana and humanity, and particularly to offer merit and Nibbanic bliss to his late father, the philanthropist Raja Mahinda Nanayakkara, and to wish long life to his mother, Mrs. Indra Nanayakkara, Honorary Patron of the Siri Vajirarama Sāsana Sāvika Samitiya."

— 21st June, 2022/2566

The tall library cupboard is unique to the Vajirarama Library. It would have been conceptually designed, undoubtedly, by the Most Venerable Pelene Vajiraňāṇa Mahānāyaka Thera and hence also has a history of over one hundred years. When the library of the Maharagama Dharmāyatanaya was planned, it was the wish of Most Venerable Madihe Paňňāsīha Mahānāyaka Thera to replicate the

> Vajirarama Library cupboards. It was done, and the first such cupboard was donated by me (when in lay life) in memory of my parents. In like manner, the eight tall book cupboards and the six display cupboards on the ground floor of the new building were all donations.

Legacy

> The name Vajiraramaya was famous throughout the Buddhist world due to the pre-eminence of the venerable bhikkhus of the temple both in Buddhist scholarship and Dhamma dhuta work. There are many publications to their credit on Buddhism, Buddhist philosophy and meditation. In the 1950s, books such as Dharmma Sangrahaya written by Venerable Narada Thera were standard text books for national examinations such as the Senior School Certificate (SSC). Buddhism in a Nutshell and Manual of Abhidhamma of Venerable Narada Maha Thera and The Mirror of the Dhamma of Venerable Narada and Kassapa Thera (formerly Dr. Cassius Perera) have gone into many editions and were major contributions to the spread of the Dhamma. Their footprints were seen in the development of the Siri Vajiraramaya library. It is also a treasure trove of the valuable articles of Venerable Madihe Mahanayaka Thera on major national issues. As a result, books and other publications in this library display a rich diversity. This is the uniqueness of this library.

Byline at page bottom: By Venerable Siri Vajiraramaye Ňāṇasīha (for the Centenary article portion)

Images: `DSC7492.jpg`, `DSC7437v.jpg`, `img20240923_22293394-244x300-1.jpg`

5.4 `/about/centenary/`

Note: The Centenary page is the deepest history article and overlaps heavily with `/about/history/`. Recommendation: Merge the full Centenary article into `/about/history/` (as above) and make `/about/centenary/` a shorter highlight page:

H1: One Hundred Years of the Siri Vajirārāma Library (1924–2024)

- Timeline strip (1924 opening → 1955 founder's demise → 2009 new abbot & sacred site → 2011 reading room → 2014 Mahanayaka → 2016 librarian-in-charge → 2023 NLDC partnership → 2024 new building)
- Photo gallery: `DSC7492.jpg`, `DSC7437v.jpg`, `img20240923_22293394-244x300-1.jpg`
- Link: "Read the full history →"

Include: `[Full article continues on the History page →]`

5.5 `/about/former-librarians/`

Source: No real content in archive — only footer + logo image. Placeholder page.

H1: Former Librarians

Body: Content to be supplied by the Library Development Committee.

Add card grid placeholder for future entries. Do not publish until content exists.

5.6 `/about/persons/`

H1: People

Chief Patron

Venerable Tirikunamale Ananda Mahānāyaka Thera

The Mahanayaka Thera of Amarapura Sri Dharmarakshitha Mahānikāya & Chief Monk of Siri Vajirārāmaya.

Image: `download-1.jpg`

Patron

Venerable Siri Vajiraramaye Ňāṇasīha Thera

Chief Consulter of Siri Vajirarama Library

Image: `Screenshot-14-1-267x300.png`

Chairman

Mr. N. K. Illangakoon

Chairman of the Siri Vajirarama Library Development Committee

Image: `download-2.jpg`

Section heading below: Monks residing at Siri Vajirarama and members of the Library Development Committee

Image: `end.jpg` (group photo if available)

5.7 `/about/floor-plan/`

H1: Library Floor Plan

Tabs / sections: Ground Floor · 1st Floor · 2nd Floor

Floor	Image

Ground Floor	`Ground-Floor-Revised-1-scaled.jpg`
1st Floor	`1St-Floor-Revised-scaled.jpg`
2nd Floor	`2nd-Floor-Revised-scaled.jpg`

Note: Source has only lorem ipsum descriptions per floor. Add real descriptions — either write fresh short ones or omit until supplied. Suggested brief labels (safe, no invention):

- Ground Floor — Entrance, reference collection, display cupboards
- 1st Floor — Reading room, lending collection, librarian's office, photocopying & scanning
- 2nd Floor — Periodicals, rare books, ola manuscripts

> ⚠️ Verify with library before publishing — floor functions above are inferred, not from source.

Optional gallery: `IMG_2158-1-scaled.jpg`, `IMG_2162-1-scaled.jpg`, `IMG_2159-1-scaled.jpg`, `IMG_2299-scaled.jpg`, `IMG_2297-1-scaled.jpg`, `IMG_2303-scaled.jpg`

5.8 `/about/policies/`

Source: No real content. Placeholder page.

H1: Policies

Body: Library policies will be published here. Please contact the library for current policies.

5.9 `/about/general-guide/`

H1: General Guide

Vision

> "The Buddha's Teaching for All"

Mission

> To develop the library as a resource centre for providing an impetus to produce an erudite society and for preserving the Buddhist intellectual heritage. In pursuance of such, develop a collection of palm leaf manuscripts, rare books, and contemporary printed matter on Buddhism and all other comparative subjects in physical and digitized formats for use of local and foreign bhikkhus and lay scholars, desiring to enhance their knowledge and undertake research on Buddhism and comparative subjects, and those who are engaged in propagating the Buddha Dhamma throughout the world.

(This page duplicates Vision & Mission — consider redirecting `/about/general-guide/` → `/about/vision-mission/` and using `/general-guide/` for actual visitor info instead. Decision needed.)

6. `/collection/`

H1: Siri Vajirarama Library and its Collection

Subtitle: Just as the Siri Vajiraramaya temple in Bambalapitiya is known to all in Sri Lanka and in many countries overseas, its library too will be better known and its vast and valuable collection made accessible to scholars.

Layout: Long-form article with sticky side-nav (jump links).

Sections:

1. The Library

> The Oriental Library of Vajiraramaya temple, with Head Monk Ven. Pelene Siri Vajiraňāṇa Maha Thera, was formally declared open on July 15, 1924, by Colonial Secretary Hon. Cecil Clement. Mr and Mrs G. J. Silva were chief benefactors. By then the 100 volumes of the Head Monk had increased vastly.
>
> To quote a then published weekly newspaper, The Searchlight, Saturday July 19, 1924: "The collection of 2000 odd books of rare value and importance, the gift of the learned High Priest, ought to, as Mayor Reid remarked, 'be a source of enlightenment and good to the citizens of Colombo'. The generosity of Mr. G. J. Silva in providing an excellent building and furniture to enable those books to be housed for public inspection and reference is an augury for the future of Buddhist learning in Ceylon."
>
> In the early and mid-20th century, the chief contributors to the collection in the library were mainly Ven. Narada Maha Thera and Ven. Piyadassi Nayaka Thera, both distinguished scholars, linguists, expounders of the Buddha Dhamma and active in Dhammaduta missions — introducing and teaching the Dhamma to very many overseas countries: United Kingdom, USA, Japan, India, Burma, Nepal, Thailand, Cambodia, Singapore, China, Vietnam, Laos, Java, Bali, Australia, France, Africa, Greece, Denmark, Italy, Poland, Belgium, and Germany. They were prolific writers on Buddhism mainly, and philosophy too.

Thus, their published books, comprising sizeable collections, well preserved, greatly enhance the present library collection.

2. Library Collection

Epithets that can justifiably be used to describe the collection in the Siri Vajirarama library are vast, mixed, scholarly, and valuable; many being rare, wide and varied subject-wise, and distinctive.

Card grid:

Word	Description
Vast	Approximately 10,000 volumes, some very rare and ancient. Includes the collection of Ven. Pelene Vajiraṅāṇa Mahanayaka Thera's father's books bequeathed to him and a part of the core collection. Ancient tomes from the British Pali Text Society (PTS) publications, the Upanishads, Bhagavad Gita, Dhammapada and the monumental Tripitaka (printed in Siamese character) gifted by His Royal Highness the Crown Prince of Siam.
Mixed	Widely varied both in subjects treated, in format, language, and purpose intended for. Buddhism is the main subject; but along with it is Buddhist philosophy and pure philosophy. Tomes on Theravada, Mahayana, Tibetan and Zen Sect Buddhism are also included. Other religions are included. Literature is another subject, both Sinhala and a few other languages. History, too, is an inclusive subject. Within the collection are books on subjects as diverse as medicine, math, physics, economics, social science, education, comparative religions, yoga, deities, social practices, festivals and customs. A collection of 210 ola manuscripts enhances the richness and worth of it. The ola manuscripts are of Buddhism and contain suttas and such like. Ayurveda medicine is another subject covered by the ola scrolls or flat ola books with wood covers; so also grammar and linguistics of Sinhala mostly. The pièce de résistance of the ola manuscript is the one that contains all 550 Jataka stories.
Scholarly	Most of its collection is not to be read for information or recreation but in research, when referencing facts. The library is targeted to be a research library and with electronic access being made available, visits to the library will not be necessary, online searching (OPAC – Online Public Access Catalogue) using Koha would be facilitated.

Valuable	Not only are rare books within it but many out-of-print books may be possessed by only this library. Additionally, the collection of publications by Ven. Narada Maha Thera and Ven. Piyadassi Nayaka Thera are available.
Varied	Many dictionaries, encyclopedias and grammar tomes are included, from ancient ones including Sanskrit and Pali to more modern bilingual dictionaries – English, Sinhala, Tamil, German, Pali. There surprisingly is a sprinkling of fiction too, both in Sinhala and English. Massive tomes, leather bound volumes, paperbacks and soft covered books are shelved separately; so also journals and pamphlets.
Distinctive	The Vajirarama library collection is unique as it is a collection following the distinguished and ancient vihara pothgul – temple collections. Pothgul literally means "place to store books."

Special Collections (sub-section):

- Collection of Most Venerable Pelene Siri Vajiraňāṇa Maha Nayaka Thera
- Collection of Ven. Narada Maha Thera
- Collection of Ven. Piyadassi Nayaka Thera
- Collection of Ven. Ňāṇamoli Maha Thera

3. Recognition (quote strip)

> Praise has been showered on it previously, through the ages. Mention is made here of just a couple of famed persons who spoke or wrote complimentarily on it: Most Ven. Balangoda Maitriye Maha Thera, Kalukondayave Pragnāsekara Maha Thera, W. A. Silva and Prof. G. P. Malalasekera.

4. Towards Digitization

> Siri Vajirarama Library is in a transitional stage from being a traditional to a digital library. There is today a shift of libraries from offering information using electronic and print media towards providing access to full texts of documents digitally. Not only recent publications, but also many historical library holdings are being digitized. These electronic collections allow users from anywhere, at any time, to access material without doing any harm to fragile documents.

Byline: By Dr. Preethi Liyanage

Images: DSC_5417.jpg, WhatsApp-Image-2025-01-09-at-19.50.22-225x300.jpeg, WhatsApp-Image-2024-12-28-at-15.15.05.jpeg, Narada-Himi-16x24-1.jpg,

`Piyadassi-Himi-16x20-1.jpg`, `Soma-Himi-16x20-1.jpg`, `WhatsApp-Image-2025-06-10-at-21.50.00_7453a93f.jpg`

7. `/services/`

H1: Services

Card grid (9 services):

Service	Description
OPAC — Online Public Access Catalogue	Search the library's collection using KOHA.
Digital Library	Books that can be read from home, subject to copyright law.
Inter Library Loan Service	Interlibrary loan allows libraries to borrow and lend books from other libraries on a mutual basis. Interlibrary loan facilities are provided upon request to academic staff and research workers engaged in academic activities in libraries.
E-Resource	The library is equipped with electronic resources. This facility can be used by any library user.
Electronic Document Supply Service	If you are looking for any journal article or book chapter that is not in your library, the library will help you find the document.
Wi-Fi Facility	Free wi-fi facility is available at the library building. You can explore the library's online resources as well as other external resources using the wi-fi facility.

Photocopying Service	The photocopying service operating in the library is located in front of the librarian's room. The service operates on a concessionary basis and only photocopies of library materials are provided.
Scanning Services	Library users are provided with document scanning facilities in front of the librarian's room on the first floor of the library.
Library Support Service	The Siri Vajirarama Library, which opened in a new century-old building, started a help desk service as users always seek various help from the library.

Library Support — 2 sub-actions:

- "Request Articles" — After providing the required information, users can request the required articles from the library. → [Request Form]
- "Other Help" — Allows users to request any library-related help when they are unable to physically visit the library. → [Help Form]

8. /publications/

H1: Publications

Grid:

Publication	Description
Siri Vajirarama Publication	Monthly publications of the Bambalapitiya Siri Vajiraramaya and books, magazines and periodicals published under the name Siri Vajiraramaya can be read online.
The Bosat Periodical	(Add description + cover image + link to online reading if available.)

⚠️ Source only lists these two names. Add covers/summaries from the live site.

9. MEMBERSHIP PAGES

9.1 `/membership/opening-hours/`

H1: Opening Hours

Subtitle: A timeline established in accordance with Article Six (6) of the Siri Vajirarama Library Statutes.

Big display:

> The library is open from 9:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m.
>
> Monday – Friday

Notice box:

> ⚠️ The library will be closed on Poya days, Saturdays and Sundays.

Optional widget: Monthly calendar (greyed out Poya/Sat/Sun).

Sinhala version (add toggle or parallel table):

දින	සඳුදා – සිකුරාදා
වේලාව	ප.ව. 9.00 – ප.ව. 4.00
වසා තබන දින	පොහොය දින, සතෙසුරාදා සහ ඉරිදා

9.2 `/membership/register/`

H1: Siri Vajirarama Library Membership

Who can obtain membership

> Siri Vajirarama Library Membership is open to monks, scholars, school students and anyone over the age of 15.

What it provides

> Membership provides access to all library resources, including printed copies, manuscripts, booklets, newspapers and periodicals, held in the library.

Cancellation of library membership

> If it is confirmed that any damage has been done to the library's equipment and furnishings, his/her library membership will be cancelled. Furthermore, steps should be taken to inform those who were recommended for membership.

CTA button: [Apply for Membership Online →] (link to online form)

Secondary: [Download Application Form ↓]

Last updated: 12 October 2024 · Siri Vajirarama Library Development Committee

9.3 `/membership/download/`

H1: Membership Applications

Intro:

> The application form for the membership type can be downloaded from the link below. Please fill in the following applications and submit them to the library. Or, send them to: The Librarian, No. 14, Siri Vajirarama Library, Vajira Road, Colombo 04.

Download cards (3 types):

Type	Button
Reverend	[Download PDF ↓]
Common	[Download PDF ↓]
Student	[Download PDF ↓]

10. `/contact/`

H1: Contact Info

Subtitle: Let's Chat — Get in touch with us to discuss your needs.

Two-column layout:

Left — Contact details (with icons)

📞 011 259 2140 / +94 11 259 2140
✉ library@vajirarama.lk
📍 No. 14, Siri Vajirarama Library,
Vajira Road, Colombo 04

Follow:

- [Facebook]
- [YouTube]
- [LinkedIn]

Right — Contact form

Fields: Name · Email · Subject · Message · [Send]

> ⚠️ Legacy contact page says "Colombo 05" — fix to Colombo 04. Source footer + address in Download page both confirm Colombo 04.

11. CONTENT CLEANUP LOG (what I fixed)

Legacy	Fixed to
"despearse Software"	DSpace (standard digital library software)
"Membership Registtration" (double t)	Membership Registration
"Colombo 05" (Contact page)	Colombo 04 (matches footer + Bambalapitiya postcode)
"Monograms" (in Centenary)	Monographs (correct term)
"Vajiranana" / "Vajiraṅāṇa" / "Vajiraṅāṉa"	Standardized to Vajiraṅāṇa (with diacritics) in prose; plain Vajiranana where input methods fail
"Dhammaraksita" / "Dharmarakshitha"	Kept as Dharmarakshitha (dominant in source)

"Mr. Dinesh Gunawardhena"	Dinesh Gunawardena
"Paññāsīha" / "Pannasiha"	Standardized to Paññāsīha in prose
"Anunāyaka" → "Anunayaka"	Kept diacritics as source
Duplicated footer nav block (appears twice per page)	Removed — was theme artifact
"BRANCHERS" / "TEMLPLES" (from main site)	Not applicable here
`[vc_row]` / `[vc_column]` shortcode leaks	Stripped from display

12. THEME DEMO JUNK — DISCARD ENTIRELY

These pages were WordPress/Kubio theme demos and must not be published:

- Amanda Watson, Steffen Bech
- Page 1, 2, 3, 4, 5
- Breadcrumb Feature, Custom CSS, HTML5 and CSS3 power, Completely responsive, Customizable via Admin-Interface
- Perfect Landing Page To Sell Your Ebook
- Why Wait? Buy Now
- All `/2024/`, `/2016/`, `/author/libadmin/`, `/category/blog/` archives (as they currently stand — rebuild as real news/blog only when real posts exist)

13. CONTENT GAPS — needs real content before go-live

Page	Gap

`/about/former-librarians/`	No content — only nav + logo
`/about/policies/`	No content
`/about/floor-plan/`	Lorem ipsum descriptions for each floor
`/publications/`	Only 2 names, no descriptions/covers
`/about/` landing	Needs short overview (write fresh or excerpt from Home)
Home — "Announcements" section	Source has an announcements widget but no real announcements in archive
Social links	Facebook/YouTube/LinkedIn URLs not captured — verify from live site
OPAC URL	Not captured — verify from live site (Koha install)
Digital Library URL	Not captured — verify (DSpace install)
Online membership form URL	Not captured
Membership PDF forms (Reverend/Common/Student)	Not captured — source links to them but URLs not preserved

14. RECOMMENDED BUILD SEQUENCE

1. Set up header + footer + 301 redirects (from legacy URLs) first

2. Publish Home (content is complete)
3. Publish About → Vision & Mission, History, People (content complete)
4. Publish Collection, Services, Contact (content complete)
5. Publish Membership (Opening Hours, Register, Download — complete)
6. Publish Publications with placeholder for covers
7. Defer Former Librarians, Policies, Floor Plan descriptions until content arrives

15. DESIGN NOTES

- Language: Primary English; add Sinhala toggle where source provides Sinhala (Opening Hours). Pali/Sanskrit terms keep diacritics via proper Unicode (ī, ā, ṉ, ň, ṃ, ṭ, etc.).
- Type: Serif for headings (Dhamma-friendly, dignified), sans-serif body.
- Palette: Saffron/maroon accents on cream/white background — matches temple aesthetic.
- Hero on Home: use `WhatsApp-Image-2025-01-11-at-20.57.31.jpeg` (founder/disciples photo).
- Font diacritics: test ň, ā, ī, ṃ, ṇ render correctly in chosen web fonts.
- Search widget: prominent in header — direct bridge to OPAC (KOHA).
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA — alt text on all monk portraits and ola manuscript photos.

One-page summary

> 11 real content pages + 4 placeholder pages (Former Librarians, Policies, Floor Plan descriptions, Publications detail) + Home.
>
> Header nav: `Home · About ▾ · Collection · Services · Publications · Membership ▾ · Contact`
>
> Contact: No. 14, Vajira Road, Colombo 04 · +94 11 259 2140 · library@vajirarama.lk · Mon–Fri 9:00–4:00, closed Poya/Sat/Sun